instaplan

PITCH DRAFT 1 · LEAVE-BEHIND

The social app for going out in NYC.

TEAM

Standard Deviants

DATE

April 2026

NYC · 2026

THE CHANGE WE'RE BETTING ON

In five years, group plans won't be made in group chats.

Discovery moved out of the group chat. Invitations moved out of the group chat. The deciding step is still stuck there — and it's the part everyone hates. Instaplan moves it out, by turning it into a fast, asynchronous, gamified swipe.

THE PROBLEM

Going out in NYC is a coordination tax — not a discovery problem.

The pain isn't a shortage of events. The pain is the gap between *"we should do something"* and a confirmed plan.

That gap is filled with browser tabs, screenshots, scattered group chats, and the loudest friend deciding by default. Most nights, the tax is high enough that nobody goes out at all.

HOW THE PAIN SHOWS UP

Three frictions, one bad night.

01 Discovery sprawl

Events live across 20+ sites with no filter for what your friends would actually like.

02 Trust gap

Anonymous five-star ratings tell you nothing about whether *your* people will enjoy it.

03 The deciding deadlock

Group chats reward whoever types fastest, not the best plan. Indecision compounds with group size.

WHY NOW

The category around the group chat is finally being unbundled.

Beli

Proved a friend-graph rating system can beat aggregate reviews.

Partiful

Proved private events scale natively on phones.

The deciding

The job users complain about most. Nobody has built for it. That's our window.

Both succeeded by pulling one job out of the group chat. The remaining job is the one we're built for.

THE SOLUTION

Instaplan is three jobs in one app.

JOB 01

Discover

Real NYC events, filtered by what your friends rate.

JOB 02

Coordinate

A one-tap "looking to go out" status that lets friends find friends.

JOB 03 · THE WEDGE

Decide

A group swipe — Tinder-style voting that surfaces what everyone agrees on and auto-sends a proposal.

The first two are table stakes done well. **The third is the wedge.**

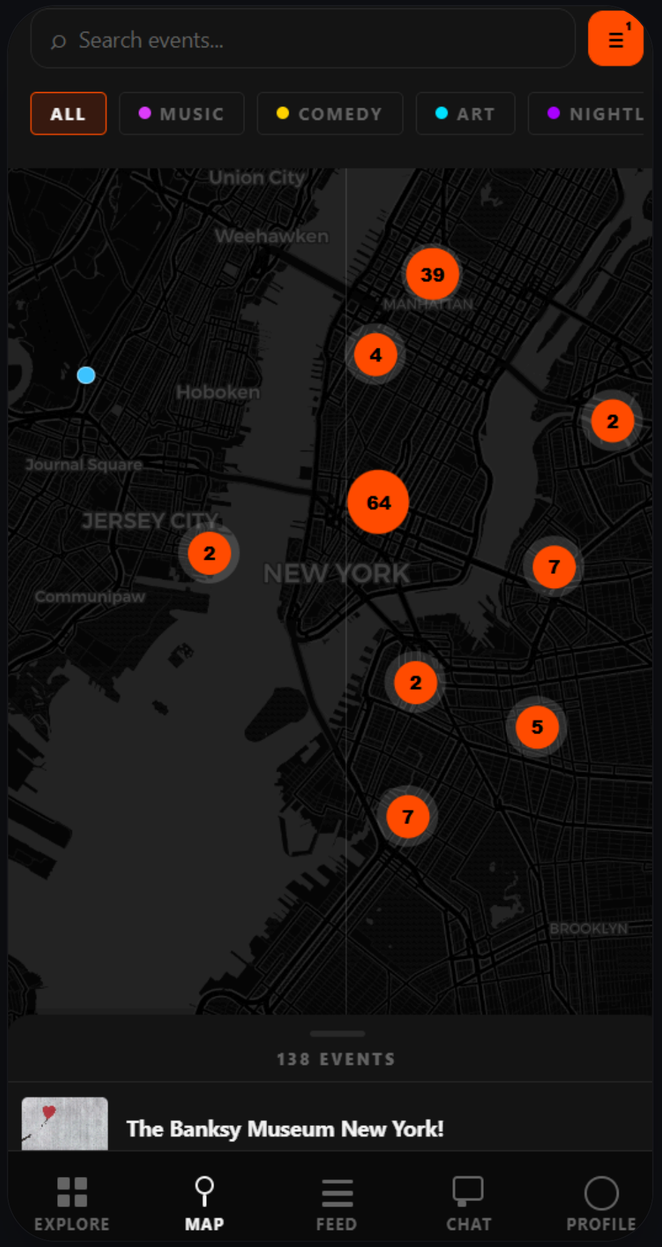
01 · DISCOVER

Friend ratings, not stranger stars.

Browse a masonry grid or map of real NYC events scraped daily from **20+ sources**.

Every event shows which friends are going, considering, or have logged it — with their ratings, photos, and notes.

Replace the anonymous five-star average with the only signal that predicts whether you'll have fun: **someone you trust already had it.**



02 · COORDINATE

"Looking to go out" turns intent into a nudge.

One toggle marks you available, with optional time and note. Friends see it on the Who's Out screen and in the feed.

The friction of texting *"what are you doing tonight"* is the reason most nights stay flat. We replace it with a passive status that opens the door without forcing the conversation.

03 · THE DIFFERENTIATOR

Group decisions, gamified.

The "where should we go tonight" group chat is broken because it forces public, real-time negotiation between people with different tastes, schedules, and energy levels. Whoever types fastest wins; everyone else opts out.

Instaplan replaces it with a swipe deck. Each member swipes through curated events on their own time. The system tallies votes, surfaces overlapping yeses, and auto-fires the top match into the chat as a proposal.

Asynchronous, not real-time.

Private votes, public outcome.

Consensus surfaced, not negotiated.

WHY SWIPE WINS

Four design choices that make group decisions stop sucking.

01 Asynchronous voting

Everyone swipes when they have a free minute. No coordination required to coordinate.

02 Private signal, public outcome

Nobody knows who liked what — only what the group landed on. Removes the social cost of vetoing a friend's pick.

03 Curated decks, not infinite scroll

The suggestion engine pre-filters by overlapping interests and free windows, so the deck is small enough to finish.

04 Gamification by design, not bolt-on

Swiping is the fun. The decision is the side effect.

PRODUCT WALKTHROUGH

Three swipes, one plan.

FRAME 01

A friend opens the proposal.

FRAME 02

Swipes right on two, left on one — privately.

FRAME 03

Plan locks in the group chat.

POLLSTERS

3 of 4 want Public Records on Friday.

Public Records
Fri 10pm · RSVP →

Auto-fired into the group chat.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY BUILT

A real app, not a prototype.

CLIENT

Expo · React Native

Shipping to iOS, Android, and web from one codebase.

BACKEND

Supabase

16 tables · 30+ migrations · RLS · realtime · storage.

EVENT PIPELINE

20+ Python scrapers

Ticketmaster, Eventbrite, Dice, SeatGeek, Meetup, RA, Nonsense NYC, Brooklyn Vegan, The Skint...

LIVE FEATURES

All flows shipped

Group swipe sessions, going-out status, event proposals, real-time chat. Tested with Jest.

We are not pre-product. We are pre-distribution.

COMPETITION

Nobody owns the deciding.

	DISCOVER EVENTS	FRIEND SIGNAL	DECIDE AS A GROUP
Beli	Restaurants only	**Yes**	No
Partiful	No	Weak	No
Eventbrite · RA · Dice	**Yes**	No	No
Group chat (status quo)	No	No	Poorly
Instaplan	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes — gamified**

Beli and Partiful are validation, not competition — they each pulled one job out of the group chat. We're pulling out the worst job, the one nobody has solved.

WHY WE WIN

We are the only app where **the deciding** is the product.

Everyone else treats the group decision as overhead before the real flow — book a table, buy a ticket, send the invite. For us, the swipe-to-match *is* the flow.

That's why our retention story is different: users come back not to discover but to **decide** — a weekly, not monthly, behavior.

TRACTION

Velocity is our trailing indicator; the slope is our leading one.

BUILD VELOCITY

One semester

Full-stack mobile app, Supabase backend, 20+ scrapers, group swipe live.

BETA · NYC

[X] users · [Y] sessions

Group swipe sessions run · matches converted to confirmed plans: [Z].

ENGAGEMENT

[—]% return-to-swipe

Users who run one swipe session and run another within 7 days.

DISTRIBUTION PIPELINE

[N] NYC venues

Contacted; [N] interested in promoted-slot pilots.

BUSINESS MODEL

Free for friend groups. Paid by the plan and the venue.

STREAM 01 · TODAY

Ticket & reservation affiliate

Ticketmaster, Resy, OpenTable, SeatGeek. We get paid when a swipe match converts to a booking.

STREAM 02 · NEXT

Venue tools

Promoted slots inside swipe decks, audience insights, RSVP tooling.

STREAM 03 · LATER

Instaplan+

Power features for nightlife regulars: deeper history, advanced taste filters, group analytics.

We never charge the user for deciding. We monetize the moment the decision is made.

MARKET

Bottom-up: NYC is the wedge.

NYC adults aged 21–35 who go out monthly		~2M
Monthly active assumption	×	5%
Monthly active users in NYC	=	100K MAU
Average ARPU (affiliate + venue)	×	~$8 / user / yr
NYC alone, modest penetration	=	**~$8M / yr**

Same product shape, swap the scrapers.

- LOS ANGELES
- AUSTIN
- CHICAGO
- LONDON
- BERLIN
- MEXICO CITY

Replicable in every city with a dense going-out culture.

TEAM

Standard Deviants.

// portrait

Saanvi Aggarwal

// portrait

Thomas Kerefoot

// portrait

Michael Karnes

// portrait

Marium Ahmed

Building together since January. Shipped a working app inside one semester.

ROADMAP

The next 90 days.

NOW → +30 DAYS

Open the beta. Sharpen the engine.

- Beta open in NYC
- Push notifications
- Recommendation algo on top of the friend-rating signal
- Google Calendar sync for the suggestion engine

+30 → +60 DAYS

Turn venues on as a channel.

- Venue partnerships
- Promoted-slot pilot inside swipe decks
- First affiliate integrations live

+60 → +90 DAYS

Prove the model is portable.

- Second-city scraper pack — LA or Austin
- Instaplan+ feature gate

THE ASK

Introduce us to NYC business owners.

We're not raising. We're building distribution.

If you know someone who runs a bar, venue, restaurant, comedy club, or nightlife brand in NYC — and they'd want their spot in front of friend groups deciding what to do this weekend — that's the introduction we want.

Every venue we add makes the swipe deck better for users. Every user we add makes the venue listing more valuable. **The ask is the flywheel.**

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STANDARD DEVIANTS · 2026